

Flash, fill: Flash used to fill shadows, even when there is enough light to otherwise take the photograph.

Flash, ring: A special circular flash that fits over a lens to take close-up pictures.

Flash, slave: A flash that fires when it senses the light from another flash unit.

FlashPix: An image format that contains a number of resolutions, each of which is broken into tiles that can be edited and displayed independently.

Floppy drive: A storage device on almost all computers that accepts 3½-inch or 5¼-inch floppy disks.

Focal length: The distance from the optical centre of the lens to the image sensor when the lens is focused on infinity. The focal length is usually expressed in millimeters and determines the angle of view (how much of the scene can be included in the picture) and the size of objects in the image. The longer the focal length, the narrower the angle of view and the more that objects are magnified.

Focus: The process of bringing one plane of the scene into sharp focus on the image sensor.

Focus lock: See Exposure/focus lock.

Frame grabber: A device that lets you capture individual frames out of a video camera or off a video tape.

Frame Rate: The number of still pictures in a given period of time.

Framing: The photographer's determination of what the edges of a photograph will be.

Freeware: Freeware is software that is available for free with no strings attached. The quality is often superb as the authors are also generally users.